Career visit: arrive prepared and follow up

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE / PARTICIPANT GUIDE

BEFORE SENDING Use as a preparation guide for an actual, confirmed experience; permission and safety requirements always take priority.

A short workplace experience can be valuable if you prepare specific questions, observe the real work, and follow up with one concrete next step.

BEFORE THE VISIT

- Read about the firm's work. Prepare two informed questions about how projects begin and what the day-to-day work involves.
- Check location, transportation, arrival time, dress and accessibility needs, and whether photography or note-taking is permitted.
- For any Jewish observance or dietary needs, raise practical details early; do not assume a host knows your requirements.

DURING THE EXPERIENCE

- Ask what surprised the professional about their field, what skills matter most, and what an entry-level person actually does.
- Look for the process, not only the polished result: revisions, constraints, testing, team decisions, and trade-offs.
- Respect confidentiality and workplace safety; do not handle equipment or photograph materials without permission.

AFTERWARD

- Within two days, send a concise thank-you note referring to one specific thing you learned.
- Write down one skill you want to practice or another experience you want to seek.
- If you promised a follow-up or portfolio sample, deliver it on time.

THREE QUESTIONS TO BRING

- What does a typical week look like, rather than the most exciting project?
- What mistakes or misconceptions do newcomers usually have?
- What small project could I try to see whether I enjoy this work?